

MGT 459 Topics in Innovation - Bringing a Product to the U.S. Market
SP26

Professor Ayelet Gneezy (agneezy@ucsd.edu)

Office Hours: By Appointment

TA: Seyi Lawal (slawal@ucsd.edu)

DATES: March 22, 2026 (5:30 PM PDT) to March 27, 2026 (10:00 PM PDT)

The course is an immersive, full-time experience running from Sunday, March 22, 2026 at 5:30 PM through Friday, March 27, 2026 at 10:00 PM, and students must actively attend and participate for the entire duration to earn course credit; no exceptions will be made. The program takes place primarily at **8980 Villa La Jolla Drive**, with an optional nearby hotel stay available for Rady students to support the long days and team collaboration.

OVERVIEW AND OBJECTIVES

The Rady School of Management at UC San Diego established a center connecting students and entrepreneurs across borders in education, collaboration, and technology translation into new market opportunities. The U.S.-Israel Center on Innovation and Economic Sustainability (USIC) empowers entrepreneurs in San Diego and Israel to jointly examine and address factors in the success of startup companies, innovation, and sustainability.

Fostering the collaborative spirit of the USIC, the San Diego Immersion course brings together up to fifteen graduate students from leading Israeli universities and up to fifteen RSOM graduate students to build cross-cultural relationships, meet local entrepreneurs and thought leaders, and apply their skills to a 48-hour business case hackathon, culminating in presentations to an expert panel.

This class does not offer tangible learning goals such as frameworks, models, etc. Yet, students will have multiple opportunities to learn by doing and observing. As loosely translated from Newton's third law of motion: you only get out of it what you put into it.

Students applying to this program must sign a statement acknowledging they have read and understood all requirements, course structure, etc., and commit to participate in *all* activities.

ASSIGNMENTS

Pre-Class

Testing: Students must successfully pass a test covering the basic concepts necessary for reading and analyzing the case. The test will be available online starting March 2, 2026, and must be completed by March 14, 2026.

Case Presentation

- Pitch Video - All teams will upload a video of their pitch to a designated google drive by March 27, 2026, at 12 PM PDT. The video can take the form of an animated clip, a narrated ppt presentation, or any other format—as long as it has all the necessary components. Please make sure that your submission can be played by each panel expert and course faculty (i.e., that does not require special software/program).
- Supplementary Materials – All teams will upload all materials they used while working on the case, including bibliography, spreadsheets used for calculations, and primary research (e.g., interviews, surveys)

Post-Class

Reflection paper: Students will be required to submit a 1-2 page paper offering reflections of their experience and learnings by Sunday, March 29, 2026, at 6:00 PM PDT. The reflection should follow the following guidelines:

- Capture your personal learnings, added value, and experience associated with the program (including concrete examples)
- Provide suggestions for future competitions
- Demonstrate thoughtfulness

GRADING

Grades will be based on the panel members' evaluations (40%), peer evaluations that will be conducted at the end of the course (at the team level; 40%), and reflection paper (20%)

KEY FACULTY & STAFF

Ayelet Gneezy, Professor of Behavioral Sciences & Marketing (agneezy@ucsd.edu; +1-858-750-0717)

Seyi Lawal, TA, PhD student (olawal@ucsd.edu; +1-973-985-2823)

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

Students with a disability or special need requiring accommodations to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine accommodations and provide the necessary documentation to the instructor.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at +1-858-534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.

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